

Hands-On: Cortex SEARCH_PREVIEW() (DDL + DML + Answers)

Assessment Type

Easy/Medium Hands-on (Screenshot-based)

Time: 20–30 minutes

Skill Focus: Cortex Search Service + SNOWFLAKE.CORTEX.SEARCH_PREVIEW() JSON parsing + validation

```
CREATE OR REPLACE TABLE FAQ_DOCS (
```

```
  ID      INT,
```

```
  CATEGORY STRING,
```

```
  TITLE   STRING,
```

```
  CONTENT STRING,
```

```
  UPDATED_AT DATE
```

```
);
```

```
INSERT INTO FAQ_DOCS VALUES
```

```
(1,'Refund','Refund timeline','Refunds take 5–7 business days after approval.', '2025-10-01'),
```

```
(2,'Refund','Double charge','If you were charged twice, contact billing with your order ID.', '2025-10-02'),
```

```
(3,'Delivery','Delivery ETA','Delivery usually takes 2–4 days within metro cities.', '2025-10-01'),
```

```
(4,'Delivery','Failed delivery','If delivery failed, verify your phone number and address.', '2025-10-03'),
```

```
(5,'Account','Change address','To change address, go to Orders > Edit Address before dispatch.', '2025-10-02'),
```

```
(6,'Account','Reset password','To reset password, use the “Forgot password” link on login.', '2025-10-01'),
```

```
(7,'Payments','Payment methods','We accept UPI, credit/debit cards, and netbanking.', '2025-10-01'),
```

```
(8,'Technical','Checkout crash','If the app crashes at checkout, clear cache and update the app.', '2025-10-04'),
```

(9,'Technical','Payment page issue','Try a different browser if the payment page is not loading.', '2025-10-04'),

(10,'Service','Support hours','Support hours: 9 AM to 7 PM (Mon–Sat).', '2025-10-01');

1 Create Cortex Search Service (DDL)

Answer (SQL):

```
CREATE OR REPLACE CORTEX SEARCH SERVICE FAQ_SEARCH_SVC
ON CONTENT
WAREHOUSE = COMPUTE_WH
TARGET_LAG = '1 hour'
AS
SELECT
    ID, CATEGORY, TITLE, CONTENT, UPDATED_AT
FROM FAQ_DOCS;
```

Hands-On Tasks + Answers (SEARCH_PREVIEW)

Task A — Basic search (raw JSON)

```
SELECT SNOWFLAKE.CORTEX.SEARCH_PREVIEW(
    'FAQ_SEARCH_SVC',
    OBJECT_CONSTRUCT(
        'query', 'How do I get my refund?',
        'columns', ARRAY_CONSTRUCT('ID','CATEGORY','TITLE','CONTENT'),
        'limit', 3
    )::string
) AS RAW_JSON;
```

Task B — Parse JSON into rows (FLATTEN)

Answer (SQL):

```
WITH j AS (  
  SELECT PARSE_JSON(  
    SNOWFLAKE.CORTEX.SEARCH_PREVIEW(  
      'FAQ_SEARCH_SVC',  
      OBJECT_CONSTRUCT(  
        'query', 'How do I get my refund?',  
        'columns', ARRAY_CONSTRUCT('ID','CATEGORY','TITLE','CONTENT'),  
        'limit', 3  
      )::string  
    )  
  ) AS R  
)  
  
SELECT  
  f.value:document:ID::int      AS ID,  
  f.value:document:CATEGORY::string AS CATEGORY,  
  f.value:document:TITLE::string AS TITLE,  
  f.value:document:CONTENT::string AS CONTENT,  
  f.value:score::float          AS SCORE  
FROM j,  
LATERAL FLATTEN(input => j.R:results) f  
ORDER BY SCORE DESC;  
  
WITH j AS (  
  SELECT PARSE_JSON(  
    SNOWFLAKE.CORTEX.SEARCH_PREVIEW(  
      'FAQ_SEARCH_SVC',  
      OBJECT_CONSTRUCT(  

```

```
'query', 'How do I get my refund?',
'columns', ARRAY_CONSTRUCT('ID','CATEGORY','TITLE','CONTENT'),
'limit', 3
)::string
)
) AS R
)
SELECT
f.value:document:ID::int      AS ID,
f.value:document:CATEGORY::string  AS CATEGORY,
f.value:document:TITLE::string    AS TITLE,
f.value:document:CONTENT::string  AS CONTENT,
f.value:score::float          AS SCORE
FROM j,
LATERAL FLATTEN(input => j.R:results) f
ORDER BY SCORE DESC;
```